

THE BATCH INVESTIGATION CHECKLIST

Seven checkpoints for finding exactly where a "successful" batch quietly dropped records.

WHEN THE SCHEDULER IS GREEN

"The job completed successfully."

A successful job proves the process finished. It does not prove the business outcome was correct.

1 SOURCE

Did the data exist? Check expected vs. available records before blaming the batch.

2 EXTRACT

Did we select everything we should? A green extract can still run the wrong query.

3 TRANSFORM

Did business logic remove records? Joins, dedup and mapping quietly drop rows.

4 VALIDATE

Did something fail quietly? Ask how many passed, failed and were skipped.

5 LOAD

Did everything actually land? Passing validation isn't reaching the target.

6 RECONCILE

Find the first gap. Compare counts at every checkpoint, front to back.

7 CONSUME

Missing, or just invisible? Filters, stale caches and permissions can hide data that arrived fine.

MISSING DATA / BATCH INVESTIGATION CHECKLIST

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|---|--|
| ☐ Root cause identified and explained | ☐ Counts reconcile at every checkpoint |
| ☐ Rejected or skipped records are understood | ☐ Missing records are restored or accounted for |
| ☐ Downstream output is verified | ☐ Monitoring or reconciliation controls added |
| ☐ Stakeholders understand what happened | ☐ The learning is documented |

REMEMBER

A green status proves the process finished. It doesn't prove the business outcome was correct.

Trace the count through Source, Extract, Transform, Validate, Load, Reconcile and Consume — find the first checkpoint where expected stops matching actual.